

Robotis (108490.KQ): Growth story intact, numerous humanoid-related catalysts ahead for Robotis and Korea-related names

Solid top-line growth in 2Q26

Robotis released 2Q26 results on Aug 14th after market close. We would note that given the limited number of consensus estimates along with the characteristics of the nascent stage of the robotics industry (thus small absolute numbers), we are focused more on annual trends as opposed to quarterly trends. However, 2Q26 numbers saw decent growth trajectory with revenue growing 95% YoY and OP increasing by 723% YoY. For full year 2026, we are looking for +153% YoY revenue growth with an OP of W3bn (note Robotis 1Q had -W12bn loss on stock compensation related expenses). Given we expect Uzbekistan ramp to occur towards 2H of this year, we expect a sharp pick-up in revenue and profits.

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2H26 and 2027 to see a stronger top-line trend

We would note that top-line could have been stronger if there weren't any bottlenecks with the production. For instance Robotis mentioned after 2Q26 results that they weren't able to fulfill all the actuator demand from key customers in 1H26 (around 66% completion). We note Robotis also had 410k backlogs in 2025 where it was only able to deliver 220k ([link](#)). This is why we are expectant on Uzbekistan capacity ramp along with further expansion in Korea which should translate easily into strong revenue trend. One of the earning drags is due to Robotis AI (the AMR business 100% owned by Robotis), which is currently making a meaningful loss due to slow ramp-up. Recently the founder of Robotis also sold partial stake ([link](#)) in Robotis to fund Robotis AI. We also believe Robotis is one of the candidates in Korea that could get investment from the Korea Growth Fund given the strong initiatives it is having in terms of humanoids and AMR ([link](#)).

Robotis showing strong progress in its humanoid business

One of the key developments of Robotis was the strong progress of its bi-pedal humanoid product AI Sapiens. We first reviewed the Sapiens in Feb-March, and also again two weeks ago, where we saw significant progress in terms of the dexterity and movements. Robotis mentioned the improvement of the Sapiens is driven entirely by software-based improvements with zero hardware modifications, utilizing NVIDIA Isaac Sim and reinforcement learning to train locomotion and balance policies in a virtual environment before deploying them to the physical platform. This transition is enabled by Robotis QDD actuators allowing simulation-trained policies to be ported to the physical robot in just three hours. Robotis also recently open-sourced AI Sapiens and its acutators. The fully open-source strategy is to have Robotis

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actuators/humanoid to be the standard for potential customers to develop their own humanoid, and potentially also a path to help early adoption in robots. Given Korean government's intention to purchase more humanoids than the existing plan ([link](#)) and Robotis's plan to showcase its product at the World Robot Conference (WRC) in Beijing from August 19 to 23, we continue to model for 800 units of external humanoid shipments from Robotis next year.

Expecting Korea Robotics names to be in the spotlight

Korean robotics names have shown a decent rebound over the past few weeks. We continue to strongly believe our thesis that Robotics is a race, and Korean companies will play a key enabler for ex-China ambitions. We highlight the upcoming Unitree listing as a potential key catalyst for interest in the sector ([link](#)). As such we expect pure play names like Robotis (in a segment where pure plays are quite rare) will continue to gain strong traction, and we also like auto-parts/actuator names like HL Mando (Buy, most recent close: W57,100) and Hyundai Mobis (Buy (on CL), most recent close: W547,000), which both still trade at valuation levels that can be explained via their current legacy core businesses, implying investors can benefit from the additional exposure. We do not make any EPS or TP changes in this note, and maintain our Buy rating for Robotis.

Exhibit 1: Robotis: 2Q26 headline results

	Prelim						
(KRW bn)	2Q26	2Q25	YoY (%)	1Q26	QoQ (%)	2Q26 GSe	vs. GSe
Consolidated P/L							
Revenue	15.4	7.9	95.1%	11.8	29.8%	19.9	-22.9%
Operating profit	2.0	0.2	722.9%	-11.8	-116.7%	4.1	-52.0%
Pre-tax profit	2.8	0.4	666.3%	-9.7	-128.9%	4.8	-41.1%
Net profit	2.5	0.1	1766.1%	-10.1	-124.8%	3.6	-30.0%
(margins)							
Operating profit	12.9%	3.1%	9.8%pt	-100.0%	112.9%pt	20.7%	-7.8%pt
Pre-tax profit	18.2%	4.6%	13.6%pt	-81.8%	100.1%pt	23.9%	-5.6%pt
Net profit	16.3%	1.7%	14.6%pt	-85.0%	101.2%pt	17.9%	-1.6%pt

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: Robotis: We make no change in GSe

	2022	2023	2024	2025	GSe (NEW)					GSe (NEW)					Chg %				
	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E	2030E	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E	2030E	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E	2030E
Robotis																			
Consolidated P/L (KRW bn)																			
Revenue	26	29	30	39	98	200	307	438	607	98	200	307	438	607	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%
Operating profit	-2	-5	-3	3	3	31	52	79	118	3	31	52	79	118	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%
Pre-tax profit	-2	-3	-5	6	6	33	53	80	122	6	33	53	80	122	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%
Net profit	0	-1	-3	5	4	25	40	60	92	4	25	40	60	92	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%
EBITDA	0	-3	0	6	9	40	65	94	135	9	40	65	94	135	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%
# of shares outstanding (mn shares)	12	13	13	15	15	15	15	15	15	15	15	15	15	15	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%
EPS (₩)	-21	-105	-239	346	306	1,712	2,731	4,139	6,302	306	1,712	2,731	4,139	6,302	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%
DPS (₩)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%
(YoY)																			
Revenue	15.6%	12.7%	3.1%	29.6%	152.5%	103.9%	53.2%	42.4%	38.8%	152.5%	103.9%	53.2%	42.4%	38.8%	0.0%pt	0.0%pt	0.0%pt	0.0%pt	0.0%pt
Operating profit	132.6%	145.3%	-43.9%	-212.5%	2.4%	807.9%	68.7%	51.3%	48.7%	2.4%	807.9%	68.7%	51.3%	48.7%	0.0%pt	0.0%pt	0.0%pt	0.0%pt	0.0%pt
Net profit	-135.7%	420.6%	132.5%	-261.5%	-12.2%	460.1%	59.5%	51.5%	52.3%	-12.2%	460.1%	59.5%	51.5%	52.3%	0.0%pt	0.0%pt	0.0%pt	0.0%pt	0.0%pt
EBITDA	-96.7%	-7588.7%	-83.1%	-1359.1%	47.1%	365.3%	62.6%	44.5%	43.3%	47.1%	365.3%	62.6%	44.5%	43.3%	0.0%pt	0.0%pt	0.0%pt	0.0%pt	0.0%pt
(% of sales)																			
Operating profit	-8.4%	-18.2%	-9.9%	8.6%	3.5%	15.5%	17.1%	18.1%	19.4%	3.5%	15.5%	17.1%	18.1%	19.4%	0.0%pt	0.0%pt	0.0%pt	0.0%pt	0.0%pt
Net profit	-1.0%	-4.6%	-10.5%	13.0%	4.5%	12.4%	13.0%	13.8%	15.1%	4.5%	12.4%	13.0%	13.8%	15.1%	0.0%pt	0.0%pt	0.0%pt	0.0%pt	0.0%pt
EBITDA	0.1%	-9.5%	-1.5%	15.0%	8.8%	20.0%	21.2%	21.5%	22.2%	8.8%	20.0%	21.2%	21.5%	22.2%	0.0%pt	0.0%pt	0.0%pt	0.0%pt	0.0%pt

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 3: Robotis: We make no change in GSe divisional forecast summary

Robotis	2022	2023	2024	2025	GSe (NEW)					GSe (NEW)					Chg %				
	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E	2030E	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E	2030E	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E	2030E				
Key financial summary																			
(FOREX)																			
W/US\$	1,292	1,306	1,365	1,423	1,467	1,450	1,450	1,450	1,450	1,467	1,450	1,450	1,450	1,450					
(Revenue by segment; KRW bn)															- - - - -				
Actuator business	24	29	30	38	60	84	143	220	326	60	84	143	220	326	0% 0% 0% 0% 0%				
AMR business	0	0	0	1	13	20	23	27	30	13	20	23	27	30	0% 0% 0% 0% 0%				
Humanoid business	0	0	0	0	14	40	62	80	105	14	40	62	80	105	0% 0% 0% 0% 0%				
Data business	0	0	0	0	12	57	79	111	146	12	57	79	111	146	0% 0% 0% 0% 0%				
Others	2	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0% 0% 0% 0% 0%				
(YoY)																			
Actuator business	0%	23%	2%	28%	57%	42%	69%	54%	48%	57%	42%	69%	54%	48%	0%pt 0%pt 0%pt 0%pt 0%pt				
AMR business	-100%	46%	310%	142%	1061%	54%	18%	14%	12%	1061%	54%	18%	14%	12%	0%pt 0%pt 0%pt 0%pt 0%pt				
Humanoid business	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	187%	56%	30%	32%	0%	187%	56%	30%	32%	0%pt 0%pt 0%pt 0%pt 0%pt				
Data business	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	368%	40%	39%	32%	0%	368%	40%	39%	32%	0%pt 0%pt 0%pt 0%pt 0%pt				
Others	5%	-100%	-200%	-399%	-100%	0%	0%	0%	0%	-100%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%pt 0%pt 0%pt 0%pt 0%pt				
(% of total)																			
Actuator business	91%	100%	98%	97%	61%	42%	47%	50%	54%	61%	42%	47%	50%	54%	0%pt 0%pt 0%pt 0%pt 0%pt				
AMR business	0%	0%	2%	3%	13%	10%	8%	6%	5%	13%	10%	8%	6%	5%	0%pt 0%pt 0%pt 0%pt 0%pt				
Humanoid business	0%	0%	0%	0%	14%	20%	20%	18%	17%	14%	20%	20%	18%	17%	0%pt 0%pt 0%pt 0%pt 0%pt				
Data business	0%	0%	0%	0%	12%	28%	26%	25%	24%	12%	28%	26%	25%	24%	0%pt 0%pt 0%pt 0%pt 0%pt				
Others	8%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%pt 0%pt 0%pt 0%pt 0%pt				
(OP by segment; KRW bn)																			
Actuator business	5	5	6	10	8	11	23	39	64	8	11	23	39	64	0% 0% 0% 0% 0%				
AMR business	-7	-10	-9	-7	-10	1	1	1	1	-10	1	1	1	1	0% 0% 0% 0% 0%				
Humanoid business	0	0	0	0	2	5	9	13	19	2	5	9	13	19	0% 0% 0% 0% 0%				
Data business	0	0	0	0	3	14	19	27	34	3	14	19	27	34	0% 0% 0% 0% 0%				
Others	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0% 0% 0% 0% 0%				
(OPM)																			
Actuator business	21%	16%	20%	27%	14%	13%	16%	18%	19%	14%	13%	16%	18%	19%	0%pt 0%pt 0%pt 0%pt 0%pt				
AMR business	-9407%	-8863%	-1939%	-612%	-75%	3%	5%	5%	5%	-75%	3%	5%	5%	5%	0%pt 0%pt 0%pt 0%pt 0%pt				
Humanoid business	0%	0%	0%	0%	13%	12%	15%	16%	18%	13%	12%	15%	16%	18%	0%pt 0%pt 0%pt 0%pt 0%pt				
Data business	0%	0%	0%	0%	24%	25%	24%	24%	24%	24%	25%	24%	24%	24%	0%pt 0%pt 0%pt 0%pt 0%pt				
Others	0%	-325%	4241%	45%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%pt 0%pt 0%pt 0%pt 0%pt				

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

108490.KQ	12m Price Target: W630,000	Price: W280,000	Upside: 125.0%			
Buy	GS Forecast					
	Market cap: W4.1tr / \$2.9bn	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E	
	Enterprise value: W3.9tr / \$2.8bn	Revenue (W bn)	38.9	98.3	200.5	307.2
	3m ADTV: W76.2bn / \$50.9mn	EBITDA (W bn)	5.9	8.6	40.1	65.2
	South Korea	EPS (W)	346	306	1,712	2,731
	Korea Autos & Industrials	P/E (X)	NM	NM	163.5	102.5
	M&A Rank: 3	P/B (X)	4.7	12.9	11.9	10.7
	Leases incl. in net debt & EV?:	Dividend yield (%)	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
	Yes	N debt/EBITDA (ex lease,X)	(39.0)	(20.1)	(3.5)	(1.8)
		CROCI (%)	4.1	3.3	13.4	21.3
	FCF yield (%)	0.3	(0.6)	(0.0)	0.2	
		3/26	6/26E	9/26E	12/26E	
	EPS (W)	(691)	172	229	596	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 14 Aug 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

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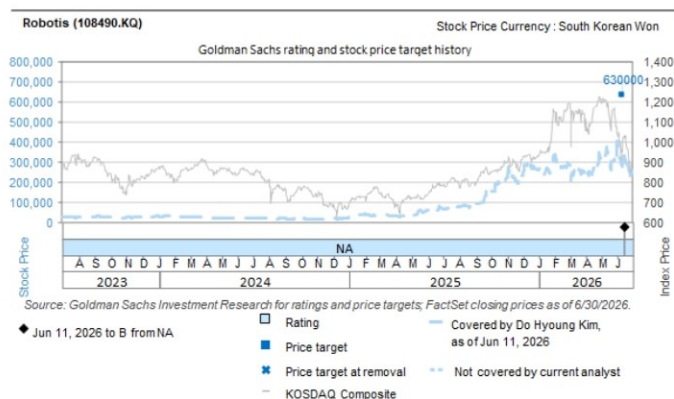
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Target price history table(s)

Robotis (108490.KQ)

Date of report Target price (W) Closing price (W)

11-Jun-26 630,000 286,500

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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